DEFENCE

Battlefield of Things 3: Trench EW Hackathon

Hacking Guide

INNOVATION FOR DEFENCE

VERHAERT | MASTERS IN INNOVATION

HACK BELGIUM LABS

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Welcome!

We're thrilled to welcome you to **Battlefield of Things 3: Trench EW Hackathon** (BoTH3), where we co-create the future of defence innovation together with the Belgian Defence and an extraordinary ecosystem of builders, thinkers, makers, and operators.

Over the next two and a half days, you'll collaborate directly with defence experts, technologists, and innovators to imagine, prototype, and demonstrate next-generation solutions for real-world operational challenges. Whether you're working on autonomous systems, sensing and communications, AI-enabled capabilities, robotics, or mission support tools, your ideas can help shape the future capabilities of Belgian Defence.

This booklet will guide you through the program we've designed to support you, from idea generation to the final demo. You'll also find practical tips to help you navigate the hackathon and get the most out of your experience.

Our organising team is here to help at all times, so don't hesitate to talk to us on-site or **Discord** channel.

We wish you an amazing hackathon - let's build something extraordinary!

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Ground Rules

1. Create something new. At Battlefield of Things, you're the innovator!
2. No sales pitches. This is not the forum for it.
3. Share your ideas. It's not about who comes up with a great idea, it's about how you can build that idea together.
4. Be constructive and positive. As a first reaction, say : "**Yes**, that's an interesting perspective, let's build on that".
5. Everybody's input is valuable. There's no hierarchy here. Everyone is equal.
6. When giving feedback, make sure your aim is to make things better and look for alternative solutions.
7. Spend more time building, less debating.
8. "It's nice to be important, but it's more important to be nice."
9. Be prepared to change your mind. A lot.
10. If you're not having fun, you're not doing it right!

Practicalities

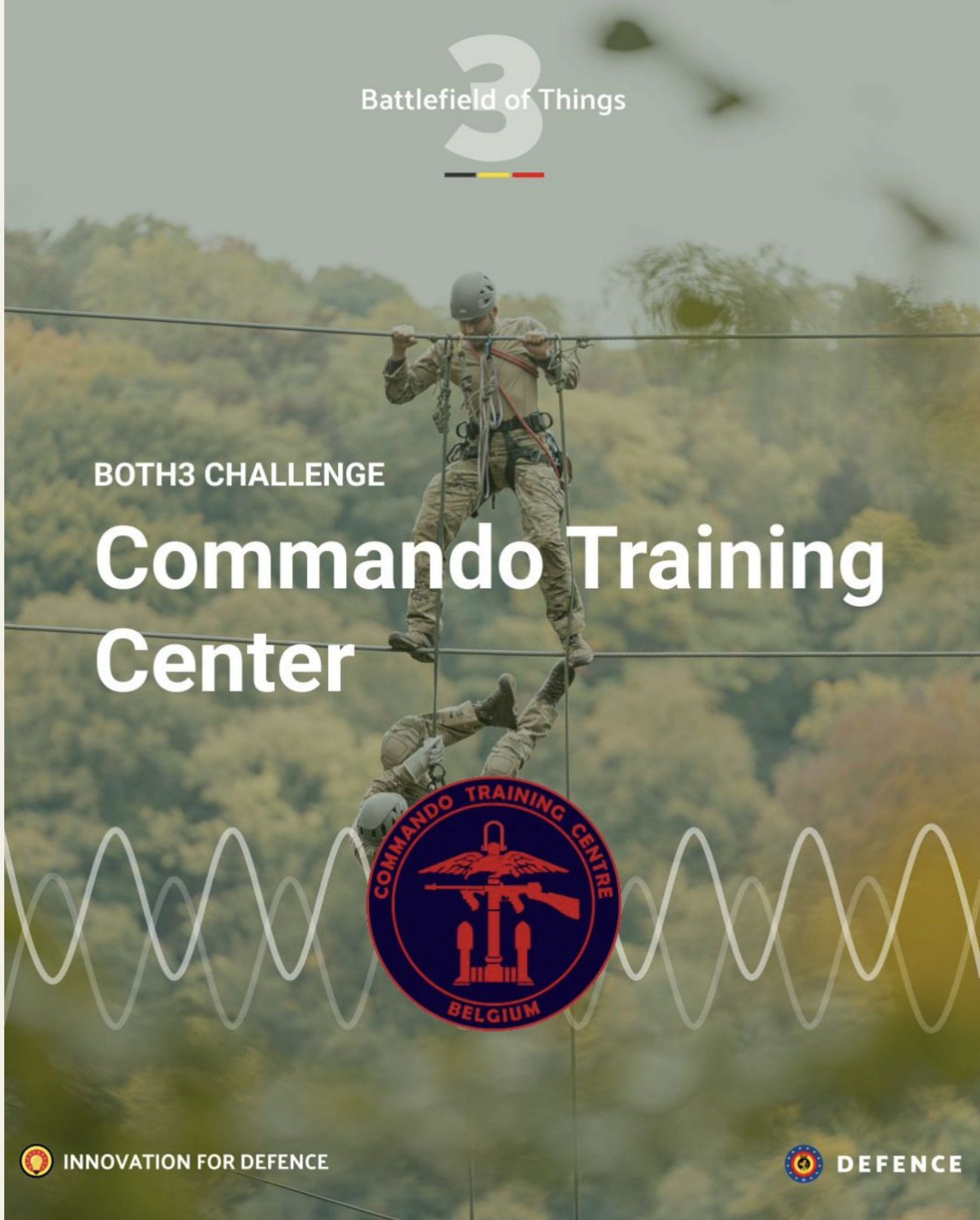
Hackathon Venue
Commando Training Center

Getting there by car:

Rue aux Vallées 43, 5024 Marche-les-Dames.

Arriving by Train:

Marche-Le-Dames train station



What to bring along
(personal items)

Sleeping gear
- Pillow + pillowcase
- Sleeping bag or bed sheets / blanket
- Towel

Personal toiletries
- Toothpaste, toothbrush
- Shampoo, soap, deodorant, etc.

For eating & drinking
- Metal or plastic water bottle
- Mug for tea or coffee

Comfort & clothing
- Slippers or flip-flops for the showers
- Warm clothes – the weather can be unpredictable

Work gear
- Your laptop
- For Mac users: HDMI adapter (to connect to screens)
- Any tools, parts, or gear you want to use for your project

What to bring along

(components)

We'll provide some components for you to use during the event (next few slides) as well as basic things you need for work - paper, markers, sticky notes - but you might want to bring along other things as well to make sure you have your familiar tools with you and don't have to wait:

- Basic tools: standard screwdriver kit, a multi-tool (Leatherman, etc.), callipers, hot glue gun, etc. and any other tools you might need.
- Your favourite soldering kit (iron, clamp, tweezers, wire cutters, 3rd hand, etc.)
- LED lights and magnifying glasses
- Pens / pencils and note paper of your choice
- Anything you might want to use to decorate your workspace and your prototypes (why not?): NeoPixels, other LED lights, etc.
- USB sticks and SD cards (including micro-SD cards), as well as SD card readers (we'll have those, but you can't ever have too many)
- Video adaptors from your computer to HDMI (in case your computer will be used for a presentation)
- A spare power extension cable - again, we'll have plenty, but you never know!
- 12-volt adaptors
- Cables: USB data cable, micro-USB, USB Type C, USB power hubs, etc.

And, while we'll have quite a few components available, you can always bring along any other components you want to experiment with!

We’ll provide

Boards	Maker	Model	Quantity *
Raspberry Pi PICO	Raspberry Pi	Raspberry Pi Pico W - RP2040	5
ESP 32	Expressif	ESP32-C6-DevKitC-1-N8	40
Raspberry Pi Model B	Raspberry Pi	RPI4-MODBP-4GB	10

Sensors and Radio	Maker	Model	Quantity
Accelerometer	TDK	MPU6050	10
Seismic	TE	MiniSense 100NM	20
Temperature	TI	LM75	10
Light	Silicon Labs	Si1145	10
Humidity	Sensirion	SHT45	10
PIR sensor - used in motion-activated lights (Passive Infra Red sensor)	Varioius	HC-SR501	20
Microwave radar	MH-ET	HB100 Microwave Motion Sensor 10.525GHz Doppler Radar Detector	10

* Our best estimate. Actual quantity may vary.

Ultrasound piezo sensor	Various	HC-SR04	10
I2S microphone (50Hz-15kHz)	Speed Studio	101020852	10
CO2 levels detector	Sensirion	SGP30 TVOC and eCO2 Sensor Module	10
Full-featured termal cameras	Pimoroni	PIM366	4
GNSS		ATGM336H GPS Module	10
LoRa	Dragino	LSN50-V2 Waterproof Long Range Wireless LoRa Sensor Node	2
AI Accelerator K210	-	-	10
NRF24L01 + Antenna - 1000m wireless comm	-	-	20
LD2420-24G - Radar human presence	-	-	10
JDY-40 2.4G Wireless Serial Port Transmission Transceiver	-	-	20
ESP32-C3 Development Board	-	-	20
Orange Pi Zero2 - 1GB	-	-	8
Raspberry Pi Compatible Cam - 5MP	-	-	10

Other components	Maker	Model	Quantity
18650 battery cells	-	3.7 V / 2.6 Ah	40
18650 battery holders - single	-	-	15
18650 battery holders - double	-	-	15
CR 2032 batteries	-	-	20
CR 2032 holder	-	-	15
Lead-acid battery	-	7Ah	5
Micro SD cards (cheapest found)	Kingston	32 GB MicroSD Micro SD Card, Class 10, UHS-I	40
Micro SD card readers	Hama		20
HackRF	Scott	HackRF One - SDR	2
Vector Analyser	URSINC	NanoVNA-F V2 Vector Network Analyzer 50KHz-3GHz HF VHF UHF VNA 4.3" Analyzer Antenna	1
Level shifter (3V3 to 5V <=> 5V to 3V3) on a breakout board	-	-	20
USB Lipo Charger	-	-	20
Step UP 3.7 to 5V-28V	-	-	30
LiPo batteries	-	EJ606090 3.7V 4000mAh	30
LED ligths RGB	-	-	30

Cables	Maker	Model	Quantity
USB cables	-	USB to micro USB	3 packs
		USB to USB C	4 packs
Ethernet cables	-	.5 meters	5
		5 meters	3
		10 meters	1

Summary of RF-tools

- Rhode & Schwarz FSQ 26 spectrum analyzer
- Tektronics RSA306B Real-Time Spectrum analyzer
- Agilent MXA Real-Time Spectrum analyzer
- 2 + 7 BladeRF SDR
- 1 Kraken SDR
- 1 HackRF
- 2 Jammers (20MHz to 6GHz)

Equipment Provided By our Knowledge Partners

Thank you!

ALX Systems will bring along:

Hardware:

- 3 drones *(2 open/unsecured, 1 secured for comparison)*
- 10x serial GPS modules
- 20x USB sub-GHz radios *(315–916 MHz)*
- 4x LTE modules *(4G Cat.6)*

Use cases for participants:

- GPS jamming and resilience testing
- Communication interception and analysis
- Drone system vulnerability exploration
- Development of anti-jamming and RF resilience solutions
- Prototyping and testing additional EW concepts

Senhive will bring along:

Hardware:

- 7x Software Defined Radios (bladeRF 2.0 micro, 47 MHz – 6 GHz)
- Antennas for 2.4 GHz / 5 GHz / 900 MHz
- Coaxial cables & RF adapters
- Use cases for participants:

Use cases for participants:

- Signal interception and spectrum analysis
- RF protocol exploration and reverse engineering
- Wireless communication testing across multiple frequency bands
- Development of jamming and anti-jamming techniques
- Prototyping and testing custom RF-based solutions

Citymesh will bring along:

Hardware:

- Rohde & Schwarz TSMA6 + ROMES (Field equipment): a passive scanner supporting 0 to 6 GHz.
- VIAVI ONA800 (Field equipment) passive scanner supports 9 kHz to 44 GHz.
- VIAVI TM500 RF Device emulator (lab equipment) simulates the load of up to 256 RF devices and allows controlled mobility scenarios

Use cases for participants:

- Field network performance mapping and optimization
- Interference detection and spectrum analysis
- Root-cause investigation of connectivity and quality issues
- Load testing and network behavior under high user density
- Mobility and handover scenario testing in controlled environments
- Validation and prototyping of network optimization strategies

BIPT will bring along:

Hardware:

- PR 200 type receivers for radio frequency disturbance
- Goniometer vehicle

Use cases for participants:

- Detection and localization of RF interference sources in real time
- Direction finding and geolocation of unauthorized or hostile transmitters
- Identification and analysis of drone communication and control signals

Thank you!

The Challenges

EPS 10

EW Force Protection

As modern conflicts increasingly rely on electronic intelligence (ELINT), signals intelligence (SIGINT), and precision fires cued by electromagnetic emissions (EM), controlling the electromagnetic footprint of military units is essential.

Electromagnetic Force Protection encompasses the policies, technologies, and practices employed to reduce the electromagnetic (EM) vulnerability of deployed troops.

How might we enable frontline units to continue exchanging useful information in the EM spectrum while reducing their detectability through smarter use of existing equipment, optimising transmission methods, or any other unorthodox techniques?

How might we prevent our field hospitals from being located and targeted through the EM signature of medical equipment?

Counter-Jamming

Modern conflict has evolved into a battlespace where any RF emission becomes instantly detectable, classifiable, and targetable within tens of kilometres. This "Transparent Bubble" severely constrains frontline communications and complicates the suppression of enemy electronic warfare (EW) systems. Counter-jamming, therefore, requires a combination of low-signature communication, resilience against deception, and high-precision geolocation to enable the neutralisation of adversary jammers.

Electromagnetic superiority increasingly depends on shrinking our own signatures while expanding our ability to pinpoint and degrade hostile emitters.

How might we create a high-bandwidth, low-signature communication link that survives intense jamming and the risk of self-jamming without becoming a conspicuous target for enemy strikes?

How might we use low-cost tools to triangulate the location of antennas, signal sources, or power supplies with sufficient precision (within 20 meters) to facilitate a "hard kill" with artillery or loitering munitions?

Detect & Intercept

With adversaries growing more adept at physical camouflage, extending sensing into the RF spectrum becomes critical.

Identifying enemy soldiers, jammers, radars, or drones in the immediate vicinity and being able to distinguish them from friendly personnel and assets based on the known signals is necessary.

How might we filter out background noise, ingest raw RF data, and notify soldiers of threats and targets in the surrounding area through a simple output (e.g. visual symbol, text, or sound alert) through TAK onto any mobile device (phone, smart watch, or headphones)?

How might we extract transmission metadata and use it to recognise patterns of enemy behaviour, moving from simple real-time tracking to predictive surveillance?

Program Overview

PROGRAM

Day 1 I May 22, Friday

17:00-	Arrivals, Registrations & Dinner
18:00	Official Opening
18:15	1st Challenge Insights & Ideation Session
20:00	2nd Challenge Insights & Ideation Session
21:20	Idea Gallery & Team Formation
22:00	End of Day 1

Day 2 I May 23, Saturday

8:00	Welcome & Breakfast
9:00	Morning briefing
9:15	Team Kick Off & Idea Refining
11:00	1st Check-in with Expert Panel
12:00	Lunch
13:00	Afternoon Briefing & Hacking Continues
16:00	Knowledge Sharing Workshops
17:50	Debrief
18:00	Dinner + Tech Show
20:00	End of Day 2

Day 3 I May 24, Sunday

8:00	Welcome & Breakfast
9:00	Morning briefing
9:15	Team Kick Off & Idea Refining
10:00	2nd Check-in with Expert Panel
12:00	Lunch
13:00	Pitch Review Session
16:15	Pitchin Sessions
17:45	Closing Remarks & Reception
18:30	The End

Day 1

Arrivals, Registration & Dinner

17:00 → 18:00

Commando Training Center
Rue aux Vallées 43, 5024 Marche-les-Dames

Prepare to be stopped at the gatehouse. There is plenty of parking available next to the venue. Please allow an additional 5 minutes for parking and walking to the entrance. Upon arrival, have your ticket ready to present. Collect your event badge, settle in, and grab some dinner.

Official Opening

18:00 → 18:15

Plenary (Bar)

Listen to the welcome briefing by Leo Exter, Chief Energiser of the Hackathon.

1st Challenge Insights & Ideation Session

18:15 → 19:45

Breakout spaces 1+2+3 (Bar+Cafeteria)

The goal of this session is to share knowledge and insight about the challenges, and to turn those insights into ideas. Pick the challenge you would like to join and go to its breakout room.

To make sure each of the challenges gets equal attention at the ideation stage, we'll ask you to make hard-and-fast choices. That's why there's a limited number of seats per room: if there are no empty chairs left in the ideation session you'd like to join, please join another session (you will still have a chance to join your preferred challenge in the second round of ideation workshops).

Challenge briefers will present specific challenges related to the themes. Everybody will have an opportunity to share relevant experiences and knowledge. A facilitator will help you all have an insightful discussion.

In the second part of the session we'll go into ideation. The main objective is to brainstorm ideas with a different group of people. Facilitators will lead the team formation and the process.

Coffee Break

19:45 ⟶ 20:00

Time to relax, grab a cup of coffee, and talk to the other hackers.

2nd Challenge Insights & Ideation Session

20:00 ⟶ 21:15

Breakout spaces 1+2+3 (Bar+Cafeteria)

We ideate all over again, but this time make sure you experience another challenge: change rooms!

TIP: CHOOSING YOUR IDEATION SESSIONS

There are two Challenge Insight and Ideation Sessions, so you can explore two different challenges: one that you already know, and one that's completely new for you. If you came with a team, split up and explore different challenges to broaden your collective perspective.

TIP: MAKE THE MOST OF YOUR IDEATION SESSIONS

When you share knowledge with the group, try to address questions such as:

- What makes this challenge hard to solve?
- What are the key obstacles?
- What has been tried in the past (by your organisation or others you may know about) and how did those initiatives work out?
- What do you think needs to happen for this challenge to be solved? How will we recognise a good idea?

TIP: IDEATION

DON'T TAKE THE EASY PATH

When discussing your ideas in a group, you may find that the group ends up settling for the most obvious, easy ideas (the lowest common denominator). Don't fall into that trap! Instead, make sure that your group is stretching your ideas beyond the obvious. Be more radical and cutting edge. Later on, when you validate your idea, there is time to come back down to earth.

At the end of the two Ideation Sessions you don't need a perfectly worked out idea yet, but you do need to pick a reasonably specific question or idea that you'd like to work on. Also, don't fixate on the idea: the people you want to work with are even more important!

Briefing & Idea Gallery

21:15 → 21:35

Plenary (Bar)

Return to the plenary to hear the briefing for the next steps. Afterwards, you will be guided to explore the ideas created during the ideation sessions. See which ones spark your imagination and inspire you most, and decide where you would like to settle for the next two days. Identify the two ideas you find most interesting.

Team Formation

21:35 → 21:45

Plenary (bar)

It's time to form a team and decide on which idea you'd like to focus on. So go to your favourite idea sheet and join the fun. The facilitator will help you choose an idea and a team. Remember, the ideal team size is 5-6 people and make sure you have a diverse mix of skills in your team.

Official end of Day 1

22:00

Time to reset and prepare for the next day. You can also use this time to get to know your teammates better.

Day 2

EPS 10

Welcome & Breakfast

08:00 → 09:00

Cafeteria

Let’s start the second day!

Morning Briefing

09:00 → 09:15

Plenary (bar)

A quick overview of what you should aim to accomplish today: expert check-ins, testing opportunities, workshops to take a short break from your desks, and more.

Team Kick off & Idea Refining

09:15 → .....

Breakout spaces 1+2+3 (Bar+Cafeteria)

This is when you actually start working with your team on the idea you chose yesterday. If you haven't done so yet, choose a table and register your team *HERE*.

1st Check-in with Expert Panel

11:00 → 12:00

Plenary (bar)

You'll have the opportunity to consult with Expert Panelists about their real-world experiences related to the challenges. Use this time to gain valuable insights and strengthen your early ideas with first-hand knowledge. The schedule will be posted on the wall in a breakout space–please review it and reserve a slot for your team by placing a post-it with your team name.

TIP: HOW TO PREPARE

Use your time wisely: you get only 20 mins, so come prepared. Together with your team, think of the three key questions you would like to ask. During the first check in with experts, try to get a glimpse into their first-hand experience.

Assign team members: your entire team doesn't have to take part in the conversation. Delegate a couple of your teammates - and the rest - keep working!

TIP: TEAM KICK-OFF

GET TO KNOW YOUR TEAM MEMBERS

What are their skills and strengths? How do they like to work? Given their answers, assign the following roles within your team:

- Project Lead (rapporteur): main point of contact and decision maker (in case of conflict), makes sure things keep moving.
- Strategists: mapping goals and conceptualising the solution.
- Delivery Managers: crafting and stretching the solution.
- Researchers: listing assumptions and questions and validating them with experts and peers.

TIP: GOAL

STRETCH THE IDEA

Continue stretching your idea by exploring how various technologies (e.g. artificial intelligence, blockchain, robotics) could make it more powerful, or how the solution might be launched or scaled up faster with the help of partners (especially those represented by team members).

THEN FOCUS

Now you need to align behind a clear and specific goal! Write down your goal on a sheet of paper and place it somewhere visible. Imagine your project is a total success: what will it look like in 2-3 years' time? Make sure you describe your solution and what it accomplishes for your target beneficiaries.

If you can't decide as a team, then individually each write 3 goals on stickies, share them in the group, all vote using sticky dots (each 2 votes), pick the winner.

EPS 10

TIP: LEAN CANVAS

The Lean Canvas is a great tool for mapping out all the key factors that will determine the success or failure of your project. Go through the canvas one block at a time and try to list both your knowns and unknowns (verified and unverified assumptions).

A useful prompt: Imagine that in one year's time your project has failed. Why did it fail? The answers to that question will give you the unknowns that you want to research.

TIP: SOLVING THE UNKNOWN

Once you have identified the big unknowns, immediately delegate people in your team to start verifying your assumptions, to turn the unknowns into knowns. If your assumptions turn out to be wrong, adapt your canvas. Keep doing so until you're as confident as you can be about everything on your Lean Canvas.

To go from unknowns to knowns, tap into the immense reservoir of knowledge that other participants represent. Don't hesitate to ask your neighbours for the information you're missing - and if you don't know whom to ask, our facilitators will help you find the right person.

TIP: USER JOURNEY & PROTOTYPING TARGET

USER JOURNEY MAP

In a hackathon you should not try to sketch out a complete product. Instead, try to sketch out one small but important aspect of the solution that you can later test with users and pitch to stakeholders. The User Journey Map will help you figure out what exactly you should be prototyping.

A useful prompt: What is the most critical touchpoint with your users or stakeholders that will make or break your solution?

EPS 10

LEAN CANVAS

Inspired by the Business Model Canvas, Lean Canvas and Social Business Model Canvas.

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This Lean Canvas is a great tool for mapping out all the key factors that will determine the success or failure of your project.
Go through the canvas one block at a time and try to list both your knowns and unknowns.
Use Sticky Notes so that you can update your canvas as you learn more.

TEAM NAME:

Table number :

2 PROBLEM

List the top 1-3 problems of your users or customers that you want to focus on.

EXISTING ALTERNATIVES

List how these problems are solved today

3 SOLUTION

Describe your proposed solution to the problem

6 KEY ACTIVITIES

What activities will your organisation be carrying out ?

4 UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

What value are you delivering for your customers or beneficiaries? How is this different & better to existing solutions? Write a simple, clear and compelling message why your initiative should exist!

KEY METRICS

What will you measure to see whether you are succeeding or not ? Pick at least one key metric.

5 CHANNELS

How are you reaching your customers or beneficiaries ?

7 PARTNERS & STAKEHOLDERS

Who are the essential organisations or companies you will need to involve to deliver your solution ?
For example, for R&D, or production, or distribution, or to secure special access or permissions.

1 SEGMENTS

List your target customers or beneficiaries.

8 KEY RESOURCES & TECHNICAL FEASIBILITY

What resources will you need to run your activities ?
People, finance, access ? What technologies will you rely on and what technological challenges will you need to solve in order to deliver your solution ?

9 COST STRUCTURE

What are your biggest expenditure areas ?
How do they change as you scale up ?

10 REVENUE

Break down your revenue sources by %

USER JOURNEY MAP

Inspired by the Map and Target of the 5-day Design Sprint

INNOVATION FOR DEFENCE

A TOOL FOR DECIDING WHAT YOU SHOULD PROTOTYPE AND TEST WITH USERS AND EXPERTS

First list up to 3 actors or personas who you want to prioritise for now. Then list the positive outcomes (Goals) for those actors after they interact with your solution. Then map the journeys by listing the key touchpoints (could be online, through devices, through human services, through partners, etc.) as they first discover your solution until they're actually using it. Finally, ask yourself: who is the most important actor and what is the most critical moment of the interaction with your solution? Circle that touchpoint. It is that interaction that you should prototype and test with users and stakeholders and experts.

TEAM NAME:

Table number:

NOTES:

1 ACTORS

List the key actors or personas (representing your beneficiaries, customers or stakeholders) you want to prioritise.

3 DISCOVERY

List the key touchpoints where your actors first discover your solution.

4 LEARNING

List the key touchpoints where your actors learn about your solution and why and how they might use it or support it.

5 DISCOVERY

List the key touchpoints where your actors are actively using your solution.

2 GOALS

List the positive outcomes for your beneficiaries or stakeholders as a result of interacting with your solution.

Lunch

12:00 ⟶ 13:00

Cafeteria

Let's regain some energy over lunch while meeting other participants.

Afternoon Briefing

13:00 ⟶ 13:15

Plenary (bar)

A quick check-in to re-energise, see where we are, and look ahead to what's coming this afternoon. After that, the hacking continues.

Knowledge Sharing Workshops

16:00 → 17:00

Breakout spaces 1+2+3 (Bar+Cafeteria)

A total of four workshops will be held simultaneously, which means you'll be able to take part in one workshop. You will have the chance to learn about Belgian Defence equipment, European defence innovation, and hear a real reservist story, followed by an outdoor activity. After all, we are at the Commando Training Center.

It's also a great opportunity to take a break from your table and connect with other experts and participants.

Debrief

17:50 → 18:00

Plenary (bar)

You've made it through the second day! We welcome you back to the plenary and cheer for tomorrow (our third and final day).

Dinner + Tech Show

18:30 → 19:30

Cafeteria

Continue the conversation over dinner and explore the expo zone created by fellow participants. It's the perfect moment to unwind, connect, and get inspired by the ideas and products already emerging.

End of Day 2 / More Hacking Time (Optional)

19:30

Plenary (bar)

The official program may pause, but your creativity doesn't have to. You're welcome to keep working with your team for as long as you've got energy!

Day 3

EPS 10

Welcome & Breakfast

08:00 → 09:00

Cafeteria

Morning Briefing

09:00 → 09:15

Plenary (bar)

Start the final day with a quick briefing to align on the day's objectives. Then, dive back into your project and pick up where you left off. Pay close attention to announcements about drone flying opportunities and instructions.

Developing & Validating Your Idea

09:15 → .....

Breakout spaces 1+2+3 (Bar+Cafeteria)

This morning your team's goal is to develop your idea in more detail and validate some of your key assumptions (unknowns). You'll also have a Second Check-In with the Expert Panel. Schedule your meeting now!

2nd Check-in with Expert Panel

10:00 → 11:00

Plenary (bar)

This is your chance to present your progress and get targeted feedback from the experts. Use this session to validate the direction you're heading, clarify any unresolved questions, and stress-test the feasibility of your solution. Make sure to schedule your check-in first thing in the morning.

Lunch

12:00 → 13:00

Cafeteria

Pitch Review Session

13:00 ⟶ 14:00.

Plenary (bar)

At this point you should start prototyping and preparing your presentation. It's really time to stop pivoting. Ideally, your prototype is the main element of your presentation. Use the tips below! Hacking stops sharp at 16:00 when we'll be collecting the slides for the pitching. During this time we will have Pitch Coaches giving you the feedback on your presentation. Book your slot with them now! See tips: Prototyping, Pitch Preparation, Pitch Review with Pitch Coaches.

TIP: PROTOTYPING

Serious prototyping is for later, but what you can do this afternoon is to create a realistic mock-up of at least one important aspect of your solution. The User Journey Map is a handy tool to figure out which aspect, but basically it boils down to a critical user touchpoint or interface that immediately brings your solution to life.

If you show your mock-up to a potential user or stakeholder in complete silence, they should immediately “get” what your solution is about and why it’s so great. If they don’t, you got a key assumption wrong - it’s back to the drawing board.

Keep your prototype as minimal as possible. Ideally it’s a sketch or a mock-up of a single screen of the solution itself, or the solution’s website, or a page of a brochure or user manual, or a poster - be creative! Is there a single-screen interface that could communicate the essence of your solution?

TIP: PITCH REVIEW WITH PITCH COACHES

We are here to support you through every step of your journey. Hence, we introduce you to an opportunity to run your presentation by the Pitch Coaches. Book the most convenient time slot for you on the schedule hanged in the breakout space.

You’ll get only 20 minutes, come prepared:

- Follow the general Pitch Preparation guidelines.
- Present your idea in 5 min, the rest of the time is for feedback and conversation.
- Bring your laptop.

EPS 10

TIP: PITCH PREPARATION

You'll be presenting your idea to the other participants and to the jury. Your presentation can take up to 5 minutes, leaving few minutes for Q&A and constructive feedback from the Jury.

For your presentation, think about the following:

- **Problem:** show you understand the problem and refer to any research you did.
- **Solution:** present your solution and how it differs from existing solutions.
- **Impact & Vision:** explain the impact of your solution and your 1-3 year vision for the project.
- **Research:** summarize all the expert and stakeholder research you did. Explain what else needs to be researched.
- **Sustainability & Next Steps:** how will you generate revenue and sustain your work?
- **Team:** who are the people & partners behind this project and how will they make it work?

We strongly recommend practicing your 5-minute pitch, and to keep in mind that less is more - fewer words, better chosen.

EPS 10

Hacking Stops (Submitting Presentations)

16:00 (sharp!)

The moment has come – it's time to wrap up and submit your final presentation.
Please upload your presentation to the designated *folder*.

If you encounter any issues, you can also email it to egle@hackbelgium.be.

Prefer to present directly from your own computer? That's fine too – just make sure everything is ready to go.

Pitching Sessions

16:15 ⟶ 17:45

Breakout spaces 1+2+3 (Bar+Cafeteria)

Every team has a 10 minute slot consisting of:

- 5 min pitch
- 5 min Q&A

The Jury and your peers in the room will provide constructive feedback and explore how the project can be taken further.

Closing Remarks (Winner announcement)

17:45 → 18:00

Plenary (Bar)

It's time to meet again in the plenary for the closing remarks and wrap up the formal part of the hackathon, listen for the 1 min pitches and hear the winners.

Reception

18:00 → 18:30

Plenary (Bar)

Enjoy some more time with your fellow hackers.

The END

18:00 → 18:30

Plenary (Bar)

Time to go home, relax and feel proud of all you have achieved in these past 3 days.

THE END

That's it. You've done a great job in these three days.
Time to go home, relax and reward yourself by
looking back at the amazing things you've managed
to do in so little time.

EPS 10

INNOVATION FOR DEFENCE

Innovation for Defence is implemented by Belgian Defence with the support of the Innovation-as-a-Service contract.

This contract is executed by a consortium of:

VERHAERT | MASTERS IN INNOVATION

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